



POLESTAR APAC WEEKLY

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 15 SEPTEMBER 2026 - 21 SEPTEMBER 2026

REGIONAL OUTLOOK

The principal APAC changes this week were the Kohat police-facility bombing and nepal Faces Severe LPG Gas Shortage Amidst Import Failures. A car bomb struck a police facility in Kohat, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa; reporting placed the casualties at Killed, 80 Injured in Vehicle Bomb Blast ; and attackers detonated a bomb and opened fire on a vehicle carrying territorial defence volunteers in Narathiwat on 18 September. The High or Extreme assessments are confined to the Kohat police-facility bombing and the bomb-and-shooting attack in Narathiwat; they do not establish the same operating condition across the region. The main continuity issue is nepal Faces Severe LPG Gas Shortage Amidst Import Failures Ratopati; and typhoon Dujuan Approaches Eastern Japan Bringing Heavy Rain and Transport Disruption SuaraGarut.ID. The lower-severity but potentially broader business change is trump extends USD 100,000 H-1B visa payment requirement for another year The New Indian Express. This distinction matters: violent events require location-specific movement and security decisions, while energy, transport or workforce measures can spread through cargo schedules, staffing and compliance even when their immediate physical severity is lower. The business response should therefore be selective. Security and travel teams should tighten controls only around the named attack or military locations and avoid converting strategic concern into unsupported closure claims. Operations teams should verify the status of any affected airport, terminal, pipeline or route before rerouting. Workforce and compliance teams should identify the employee groups actually caught by the reported policy change. A broader regional escalation would require evidence that one of these local effects is spreading into a major transport corridor, operating site or critical supply chain; absent that transmission, the report supports local controls rather than a general change in regional posture.



REGIONAL RISK PICTURE

The week's risk picture has two different scales. Physical-security events are acute but geographically narrow. Pakistan: The immediate exposure is to personnel safety and security-site access; the assessment depends on whether the incident remains contained, prompts new restrictions or produces repeat disruption around the named location; and thailand: The immediate exposure is to personnel safety and security-site access; the assessment depends on whether the incident remains contained, prompts new restrictions or produces repeat disruption around the named location Their regional importance comes from what could follow, not from an assumption that the first incident already disrupted every nearby business. A repeat attack, a wider security cordon or restrictions on a transport node would convert a local threat into an operating constraint; without that evidence, exposure remains concentrated around the named locations. Continuity developments have a different transmission path. Nepal: The development is relevant to compliance and market access, business continuity; its significance depends on whether the named access, continuity or compliance effect persists; japan: Flood exposure can interrupt roads, border crossings, sites and local supply routes; continuity plans should be tied to official warnings and reopening notices; and nepal: The development is relevant to transport and supply chains, business continuity; its significance depends on whether the named access, continuity or compliance effect persists These events matter when a damaged asset or suspended service removes an alternative used by cargo, travellers or suppliers. Duration is therefore more important than headline intensity. A short suspension with available rerouting is manageable; prolonged loss of capacity, congestion at the substitute route or an unresolved repair schedule would spread the effect. Policy exposure is broader but normally slower. New Zealand: The measure changes workforce eligibility, documentation or travel planning; the practical effect depends on the effective rule and affected worker categories The affected population, implementation timetable and treatment of existing permissions determine the real business burden. Companies should avoid applying a nationality-, visa- or market-specific rule to unaffected staff or operations. Across the selected evidence, there is no basis for one regional risk level. Security controls should follow the attack geography; logistics controls should follow verified service status and available alternatives; workforce controls should follow the exact scope of the rule. The cross-domain risk is highest where these pressures overlap-for example, a security event that closes the only practical route, or a workforce restriction that reduces recovery capacity during a disruption. That overlap is not yet established across the region, but it is the threshold that would change the assessment.

KEY DEVELOPMENTS

PAKISTAN PAKISTAN SECURITY FORCES ATTACK

[Armed Conflict](#) · [Extreme](#) · 18 Sep 2026

ASSESSMENT: A car bomb struck a police facility in Kohat, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa; reporting placed the casualties at Killed, 80 Injured in Vehicle Bomb Blast .

POLESTAR VIEW: The event is most consequential if follow-on security measures restrict access around Pakistan, disrupt nearby operations or indicate a wider pattern rather than a contained incident.

7-DAY INDICATOR: Track security notices for Pakistan, repeat attacks, access restrictions, casualty updates and any confirmed effect on nearby transport or operating sites.

SOURCES: Ratopati; thepamphlet.in; Pragativadi; Bangkok Post; Revoi.in

NEPAL NEPAL FACES SEVERE LPG GAS SHORTAGE AMIDST IMPORT FAILURES

[Operational Disruption](#) · [Moderate](#) · 20 Sep 2026

ASSESSMENT: Nepal Faces Severe LPG Gas Shortage Amidst Import Failures Ratopati

POLESTAR VIEW: The significance is confined to the named market unless the effect persists, spreads geographically or creates cross-border consequences.

7-DAY INDICATOR:

SOURCES: Ratopati

JAPAN SEVERE WEATHER DISRUPTS CRITICAL INFRASTRUCTURE

[Weather & Natural Hazards](#) · [Moderate](#) · 21 Sep 2026

ASSESSMENT: Typhoon Dujan Approaches Eastern Japan Bringing Heavy Rain and Transport Disruption SuaraGarut.ID

POLESTAR VIEW: This is a geographically concentrated continuity risk; the assessment would worsen if river levels, road closures or warnings extend into commercial corridors.

7-DAY INDICATOR: Track official warnings, river levels, road or airport closures and confirmed reopening times.

SOURCES: SuaraGarut.ID

NEW ZEALAND MIGRATION POLICY CHANGES WORKFORCE ACCESS

[Regulatory](#) · [Moderate](#) · 19 Sep 2026

ASSESSMENT: Trump extends USD 100,000 H-1B visa payment requirement for another year The New Indian Express

POLESTAR VIEW: This is a transition risk: the business effect will be set by the implementation timetable and the practical interpretation of new eligibility rules.

7-DAY INDICATOR: Watch official implementation guidance, employer-facing instructions and any change to the effective timetable.

SOURCES: The New Indian Express

THAILAND | NARATHIWAT BOMB, SHOOTING ATTACK ON DEFENCE VOLUNTEER TRUCK IN NARATHIWAT

[Armed Conflict](#) · [High](#) · 18 Sep 2026

ASSESSMENT: Attackers detonated a bomb and opened fire on a vehicle carrying territorial defence volunteers in Narathiwat on 18 September.

POLESTAR VIEW: The event is most consequential if follow-on security measures restrict access around Narathiwat, disrupt nearby operations or indicate a wider pattern rather than a contained incident.

7-DAY INDICATOR: Track security notices for Narathiwat, repeat attacks, access restrictions, casualty updates and any confirmed effect on nearby transport or operating sites.

SOURCES: Bangkok Post

NEPAL NEPAL FACES LP GAS SHORTAGE AMIDST SUPPLY CHAIN QUESTIONS

[Operational Disruption](#) · [Moderate](#) · 18 Sep 2026

ASSESSMENT: Nepal Faces LP Gas Shortage Amidst Supply Chain Questions Ratopati

POLESTAR VIEW: The significance is confined to the named market unless the effect persists, spreads geographically or creates cross-border consequences.

7-DAY INDICATOR:

SOURCES: Ratopati

BUSINESS IMPLICATIONS

People and travel: Pakistan: The immediate exposure is to personnel safety and security-site access; the assessment depends on whether the incident remains contained, prompts new restrictions or produces repeat disruption around the named location; and thailand: The immediate exposure is to personnel safety and security-site access; the assessment depends on whether the incident remains contained, prompts new restrictions or produces repeat disruption around the named location. Operations and assets; supply-chain and logistics continuity: Nepal: The development is relevant to compliance and market access, business continuity; its significance depends on whether the named access, continuity or compliance effect persists; and japan: Flood exposure can interrupt roads, border crossings, sites and local supply routes; continuity plans should be tied to official warnings and reopening notices. Regulatory and market-access: New Zealand: The measure changes workforce eligibility, documentation or travel planning; the practical effect depends on the effective rule and affected worker categories.

7 DAY WATCH

ISLAMABAD, PAKISTAN – PTI nationwide protest and long march to Islamabad

Watch: Track route and venue advisories, transport changes and police restrictions.

JAKARTA, INDONESIA – National Farmers Day, Semanggi II and Black September demonstrations

Watch: Track venue advisories, organiser confirmation and any police restrictions.

JAKARTA, INDONESIA – Conditional KPSI Employment Bill labour demonstration

Watch: Track venue advisories, organiser confirmation and any police restrictions.

INDIA – Bank strike from September 28: SBI issues advisory on possible service disruptions

Watch: Track organiser confirmation, transport changes and cancellation or postponement notices.

POLESTAR OUTLOOK

The next-week judgement is not that APAC faces uniform deterioration. The question is whether the current events remain bounded to their reported locations or begin to affect the systems businesses depend on. In Pakistan and Thailand, repeat attacks, new checkpoints, displacement or official access restrictions would be the first evidence of escalation beyond the incidents already recorded. Continuity risk is concentrated in Nepal and Japan. Verified restoration, loading, routing or service notices will show whether the disruption is clearing; sustained suspension or diversion would justify a stronger logistics response. In New Zealand, the important signal is implementation: affected eligibility classes, effective dates and employer obligations matter more than further political commentary. The specific indicators are Track security notices for Pakistan, repeat attacks, access restrictions, casualty updates and any confirmed effect on nearby transport or operating sites; track official warnings, river levels, road or airport closures and confirmed reopening times; official implementation guidance, employer-facing instructions and any change to the effective timetable; and track security notices for Narathiwat, repeat attacks, access restrictions, casualty updates and any confirmed effect on nearby transport or operating sites. Stabilisation would be indicated by restored operations, no repeat attack, and narrowly scoped implementation guidance. Deterioration would require the opposite: repeated violence near operating nodes, a disruption extending into a major route, or a policy measure broadening to additional workforce or market-access groups.

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